From Connection Loss to Collision: Closed-Loop Fault Assessment of a Fly-Connectome SNN

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***Abstract*—We assess how connection loss affects action timing and first contact in a fly-connectome spiking network, using 576 test episodes organized into paired campaigns. Both feedback laws complete 48/48 healthy RF-0 tasks. At 50% connection-row deletion, proportional/relay 1-s success is 37/48 versus 48/48; the prespecified secondary net-loss contrast is -22.9 pp (95% whole-seed CI $[-33.3, -12.5]$). Recalibrated RF-A/B each yield an uncertain -4.2 pp $[-12.5, 0]$; unequal reserve, recalibration and cohorts limit attribution. Shared action schedules yield law-discordant contacts, while a frozen command warning detects only 2/13 RF-0 contacts. To quantify audit value, we froze 111 additional software fixtures across two plants. Full checks detect 81/87 corruptions versus 36/87 for trusted-header checks, rejecting 0/24 valid controls; six fly corruptions remain undetected. Historical re-scoring revises terminal-burst counts from 13/17 to 7/17. These measurements connect conditional task preservation with quantified audit information and explicit blind spots.**

***Index Terms*—spiking neural networks, fault assessment, closed-loop control, reproducibility**

I. Introduction and Positioning

How does matched connection loss in a connectome-derived spiking neural network (SNN) affect first contact as feedback, observation horizon and calibrated sensing change? We pair healthy and damaged runs, resolving neural commands, action timing and contact separately.

Shiu's connectome-derived LIF model [1] supplies commands to our synthetic pursuit–escape plant. An [2] studies task/state-dependent sparsification; Jo [3] links damaged circuits to virtual-arena behavior. We quantify paired first contact under frozen laws and horizons, and test future-contact warnings from a fixed 400-ms prefix.

DriveFI searches closed-loop safety violations [4]; SpikeFI, SpikingJET and enpheeph provide SNN fault injection [5]–[7]. Common random numbers [8], trajectory monitoring [9], benchmarking [10], [11] and physical fault propagation [12] are established. Our ablation tests which pairing, timing and native-replay obligations add findings beyond trusted record identities.

We contribute: (i) stage-resolved paired timing/contact measurements, including law-discordant outcomes under shared schedules and horizon-sensitive, uncertain RF transfer; (ii) frozen-prefix warnings with 11/13 missed RF-0 contacts and cross-configuration false alarms; and (iii) a frozen-checker ablation quantifying complementary findings, misses, costs and historical reporting bias across fly and tank adapters. Timing remains descriptive; the engineering comparison tests audit information, not neural authenticity.

II. Neural Experiment and Statistical Design

A. Network, Feedback and Calibration

The FlyWire v783-derived model [13] has 138,639 LIF neurons and 15,091,983 signed, contact-weighted connection rows; cell labels use FlyWire annotations [14]. Shiu parameters [1] run in Brian 2 [15], with 0.1-ms steps, 2.2-ms sensory refractoriness and state/weight restoration per episode. Assumed RFs stimulate 104 LC4 and 210 LPLC2 cells; eight descending cells provide command features (Fig. 1(a–c)).

Between events, $\dot{v} = (v_0 - v + g)/(20\,\mathrm{ms})$ and $\dot{g} = -g/(5\,\mathrm{ms})$. At -45 mV, reset $(v, g) = (v_0, 0)$, $v_0 = -52$ mV; both derivatives pause during refractoriness. Recurrent events add 0.275 mV per signed contact to g after 1.8 ms; external events add 68.75 mV to v.

Input starts at 100 ms with visual period $\delta_\mathrm{v} = 0.020$ s. In degrees, β is world bearing minus heading, $a = (180/\pi)\arctan(0.05/d)$ is half-angle at separation d, $\sigma = \max(30^\circ, a)$ and $\ell = (a - a_\mathrm{prev})/\delta_\mathrm{v}$:

$$\begin{aligned} u &= \mathrm{clip}_{[0,1]}[\ell_+ e^{-a/60}/150], \\ \lambda_i &= \mathrm{clip}_{[0,150]}[150 w_i u e^{-[\mathrm{wrap}(\phi_i-\beta)^2+\psi_i^2]/(2\sigma^2)}]\ \mathrm{Hz}. \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

Pre-cue $u = 0$ masks the initial analytic expansion; the 100-ms input uses 80–100-ms angle history. Wrap maps to $[-180^\circ, 180^\circ)$. RF azimuth/elevation ϕ_i, ψ_i set $w_i = 1$ for LC4 and $1 + 0.8(\psi_i + 30)/90$ for LPLC2; other external rates are zero. A 0.3-m/s pursuer starts 0.25 m away at $\pm 30^\circ$ and targets the agent's segment-start position. Linear segments use starting headings; agent heading updates at segment end, capped at $\pm 100^\circ$. Decisions apply next frame. First trigger starts a heading-fixed 0.35-m/s burst 250 ms later for 450 ms; otherwise speed is 0.05 m/s. Actuator events split segments; first contact is solved within them at 0.05-m center separation. Failure latches; resources continue to $H = 1$ s; warnings use pre-contact data.

Per map, 20 passive development episodes (four seeds, five bearings in $[-60^\circ, 60^\circ]$) fit affine score z. Standardized eight-cell five-frame means at frame ends $200 \le t \le 400$ ms predict bearing/60° with ridge penalty 10 and an unpenalized intercept. Trigger threshold is half the development tenth percentile of 200–300-ms episode command means, floored at 2.5 Hz. Before cue or below threshold, steering is zero; otherwise P/R apply $-600\,\mathrm{clip}(z, -1, 1)/-600\,\mathrm{sgn}(z)$ deg/s outside the burst. Eight held-out validation clusters per RF

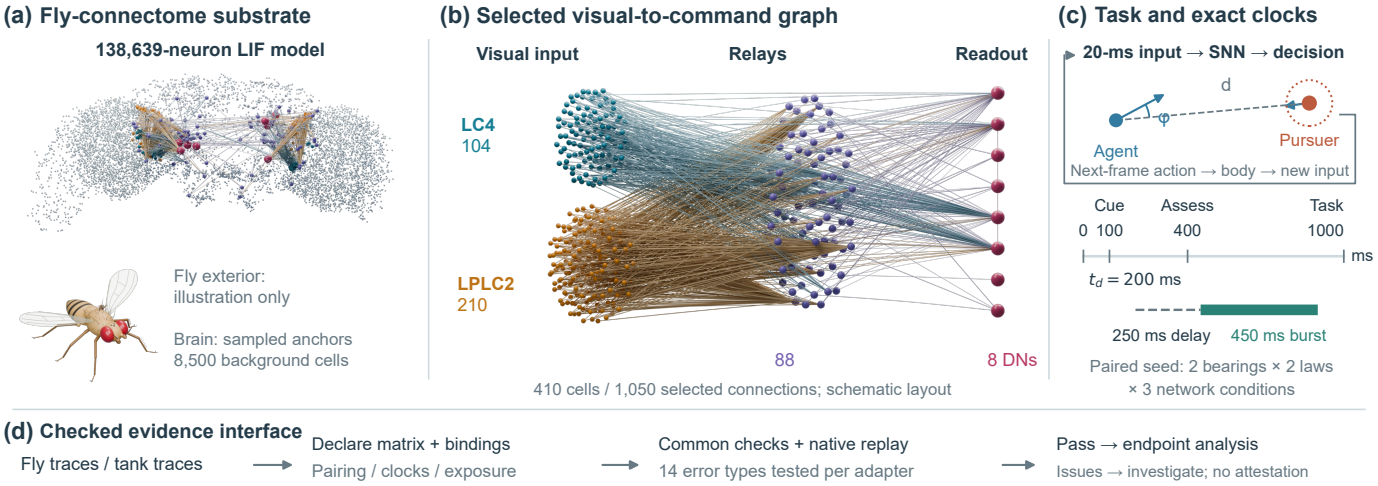
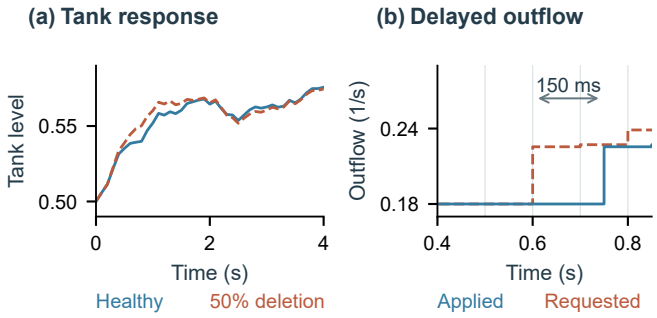


Fig. 1. System and checked assessment interface. (a) Representative model anchors and an illustrative fly; (b) a selected 410-cell/1,050-connection graph. The layout is schematic, not measured neurites or the complete recurrent graph. (c) Sampled feedback and exact burst events; $t_d = 200$ ms is illustrative. (d) Native traces enter common checks and independent replay before endpoint analysis.



(c) Fixed additional errors detected

	A	B	C	D
Fly (45)	18	27	39	**39**
Tank (42)	18	27	36	**42**

False rejects: 0/12 valid cases per plant, all arms

Fig. 2. Cross-plant example and frozen-checker ablation. (a) First tank seed, high inflow, proportional law; zoomed level axis, safe interval $[0.2, 0.8]$; all 96 tasks remain safe. (b) Requested outflow at 0.60 s applies at 0.75 s on 100-ms frames. (c) Invalid cases detected: A headers, B=A+common, C=A+native, D=full. Fly/tank invalid denominators are 45/42, with 12 valid controls each. Designed cases are not general coverage.

give RMSE $65.9°/67.8°/67.2°$: these measure continuous-angle error, not directional sign accuracy.

B. Pairing, Cohorts and Endpoints

Shared uniforms give nested deletions $w_j^{(f)} = w_j \mathbf{1}[V_{sj} \geq f]$ and input events $\mathbf{1}[U_{sk\tau i} < \lambda_{ki}\Delta t]$. Indices denote seed s, frame k, neural step τ, cell i and connection row j; $\Delta t = 10^{-4}$ s. Feedback changes λ, while input variates and row masks remain paired. Seeds and hashes are traceable, without cross-platform bit-identity guarantees.

RF-0/A/B use 24/12/12 independent test clusters, each containing both bearings, two laws and healthy/25%/50% deletion: 288/144/144 episodes. New maps independently redraw 314 azimuths from the same hemisphere prior (left $10–90°$, right $-90–-10°$), preserving identities, elevation and gradients. Each repeats the frozen development recipe, validates on 32 healthy episodes in eight separate clusters, then freezes thresholds. All maps, seeds and failures remain; no test tuning or efficacy stopping occurs. Transfer includes recalibration, not zero-shot or RF-isolated causality.

With $Y = 1$ meaning no contact through H, registered primary endpoints are paired loss $L = Y_H(1 - Y_F)$, gain $G = (1-Y_H)Y_F$ and activity exposure. Net loss $D = L-G$ is derived. The relay-minus-proportional contrast and warnings are prespecified secondary; trigger-timing, stage and clearance/heading diagnostics are post-hoc. For cumulative spikes S and $T_* = \min(T_F, T_H)$, own-stop and common-duration ratios are

$$R_{\text{stop}} = \frac{S_F(T_F)}{S_H(T_H)}, \qquad R_{\text{common}} = \frac{S_F(T_*)}{S_H(T_*)}. \tag{2}$$

Here T is contact-frame end or H, at 20-ms resolution. Common duration remains outcome-dependent and does not equate sensory histories; fixed 400-ms/1-s windows are separate endpoints.

Binary loss/gain average both bearings within seed, then seeds. Exposure uses the median of paired ratios, retaining both bearings; warnings pool trial-level confusion counts. Pointwise 95% CIs resample whole seeds 20,000 times (RNG 20261022 for RF-0; 20261023 for transfer), retaining their complete condition matrix and recomputing the corresponding statistic. CIs condition on stored maps/calibrations. Symmetric-null sign-flip tests use separate Holm families for two baseline and four transfer contrasts. Maps and separate angle/action cohorts are not pooled.

Warnings use only the 400-ms prefix. Command count C sums eight cells across fifteen 20-ms bins in 100–400 ms;

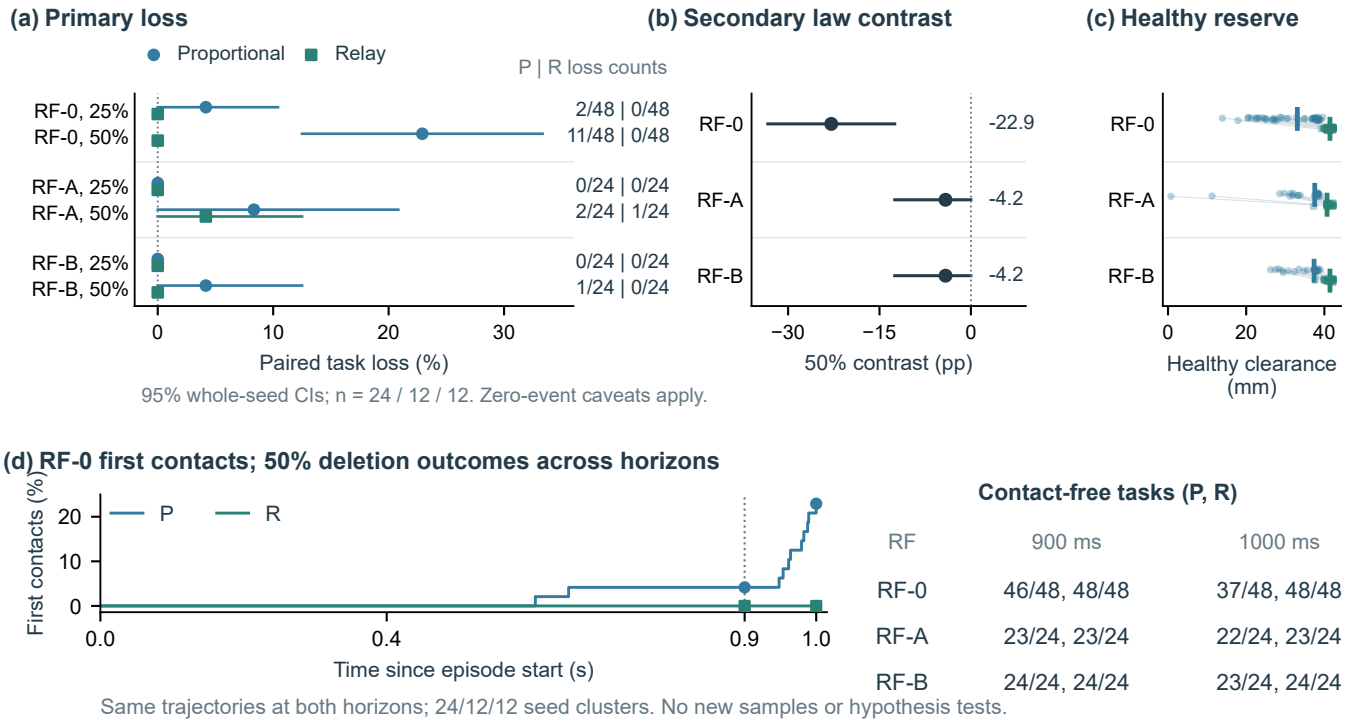


Fig. 3. Paired loss across sensory realizations and horizons. (a) Primary losses and (b) prespecified secondary R-minus-P contrasts (percentage points), with pointwise 95% whole-seed CIs, $n = 24/12/12$, conditional on saved calibrations. All healthy tasks succeed; no gains occur. (c) Paired healthy minimum-clearance points and median marks show unequal reserve. (d) RF-0/50% first contacts and all-map 900/1000-ms success counts (P, R); both endpoints reuse the same 24/12/12 seed clusters, not new replicates or tests. Maps differ in draws, recalibration and cohorts, not an isolated RF effect.

saved rates are exact 50-Hz multiples, allowing lossless integer recovery. Each 32-record healthy validation set gives a linear/type-7 fifth percentile: 14/14.55/13.55 counts in RF-0/A/B. The frozen strict rule $C < Q_{.05}$ does not flag ties; displayed $C/2.4$ Hz never determines the label. Activity uses a law/bearing-specific healthy reference and a frozen 95th-percentile absolute-log-ratio cutoff; an upper-only comparator flags ratios above two. Forecast uses exact simulated state and pending actuation, holding the current turn; if untriggered at 400 ms it assumes a 420-ms trigger. Its schedule-only baseline sets future turn to zero. Each RF freezes its fifth-percentile forecast cutoff on healthy validation; these forecasts are not neural-only detectors.

Transfer worker-lifetime peaks were 1.20–1.21 GiB on Xeon W-2223/31.6 GiB RAM. Elapsed times for 576 test episodes sum to 29.55 h (median 167 s), not CPU-hours or campaign duration.

III. Executable Evidence Contract

Campaigns declare seed, condition, law, fault, horizon, frame and resource unit. Adapters normalize native traces and bind sources, maps, calibration, input/mask digests, resources and first failure (Fig. 1(d)). Shared variates need not yield equal feedback-dependent event hashes; prefixes exclude future labels.

The second plant obeys $\dot{h} = I - u - 0.04h$, $h(0) = 0.5$, safe interval $[0.2, 0.8]$. Eight seeds, two inflows, two laws and three sensor-deletion levels give 96 safe examples; missing samples hold their last value (Fig. 2(a)). Native replay checks analytic transitions and 150-ms actuation on a 100-ms grid (Fig. 2(b)).

We froze 111 additional raw-record fixtures before scoring: 87 corruptions and 24 valid controls (107 distinct inputs). Three source blocks per family cover identity, timing, outcomes, exposure and resources, with legal off-grid events, real worker partitions and feedback-dependent histories. Earlier 14-type development challenges are separate. This author-designed catalogue is not blind generalization evidence.

Arm A checks schema, matrix membership and trusted input/configuration/mask headers, not whole-record hashes. B adds the unchanged common audit; C adds native input/plant and seeded-mask replay; D combines them. All arms normalize identical raw rows without short-circuiting; trusted-registry setup is timed separately.

IV. Results and Conditional Interpretation

A. First-Contact Loss Depends on the Declared Horizon

Fig. 3(a) reports paired losses; Fig. 3(d) rescores the same 50%-deletion trajectories at 900/1000 ms across all RFs. RF-0 has nine additional P contacts in the final 100 ms (latest 999.962 ms); law-discordant RF-A/B contacts also occur after 900 ms. These descriptive rescorings add neither samples nor confirmatory tests; RF-0's repeated endpoints were registered.

The prespecified secondary R-minus-P net-loss contrast (Fig. 3(b)) was -22.9 pp (95% CI $[-33.3, -12.5]$; Holm

$p = 0.00195$). A/B each yielded -4.2 pp, CI $[-12.5, 0]$ (all four transfer Holm $p = 1$; one nonzero seed per 50% contrast). This establishes neither equivalence nor an isolated RF effect; no between-map test was run. RF-0/25% remains uncertain ($p = 0.50$). A/B have no 25% loss; twelve event-free clusters permit a one-sided 95% upper bound of 22.1% for any loss in a new two-bearing cluster.

All 576 records triggered. Post-hoc fault-minus-healthy trigger-time differences at 50% deletion averaged 80.0/57.5/57.5 ms in RF-0/A/B (SD 42.9/46.6/29.7 ms across 48/24/24 bearing pairs; 24/12/12 independent seeds, P/R duplicates counted once). Trigger means first post-cue crossing by the eight-cell five-frame mean at 20-ms resolution. All 288 P/R pairs shared trigger/burst schedules under pre-trigger gating, yet 15 had different contact outcomes. Both RF-0 25% P contacts occurred without delay: timing alone neither determines outcome across laws nor accounts for every contact.

Among 543 records with no contact by burst completion and positive follow-up, all 3,114 decisions at/after burst end and before contact/H had zero eight-cell features and gated turn; 474 retained whole-network spikes. Thirteen later contacts fall in this observed walking regime, not a universal silence rule or isolated delay mechanism. Exclusions are four prior contacts, 17 ongoing bursts and 12 zero-follow-up records.

Fig. 3(c) shows paired healthy minimum-clearance points and vertical median marks: RF-0 P/R medians 33.1/41.4 mm; 400-ms absolute headings $88.3°/100°$. The contrast compares complete controllers with unequal healthy reserve. Burst-end state and follow-up are possible contributors; RF calibration and cohorts vary together, precluding isolated mechanisms.

B. Frozen Scalar Warnings Miss Subsequent Contacts

Across healthy/25%/50%, command warnings detect 2/13, 2/3 and 0/1 contacts (RF-0/A/B; Fig. 4(a)); false alarms are 51/275, 42/141 and 24/143 (Fig. 4(b)). Exact-count labels/CIs are unchanged; alternative rate arithmetic alerts on 19 ties ($C = 14$). Upper-only activity detects none. Exact-state forecasts detect all contacts but falsely flag 57/275, 25/141 and 33/143 successes; schedule-only flags 84/275. Extra geometry/actuation information precludes neural-only comparison.

Sensitivities rely on 12/2/1 failure clusters. Of 20,000 resamples, 2,217/7,099 lack positives in A/B and are omitted only for the corresponding conditional rate; zero-width intervals imply no zero-risk guarantee. Own-stop/common-duration medians differ by less than 0.006. P/50% median 400-ms/1-s activity ratios are 0.981/1.505, 0.961/1.212 and 0.956/1.139. A separate eight-cluster $\pm 45°$ test flags 22/32 healthy activity records with uncertain law contrast. These results bound the frozen criteria, not all monitoring.

C. Audit Gain and Reporting Impact

For 87 corruptions, arms A/B/C/D detected 36/54/75/81 (Fig. 2(c)), rejecting 0/24 controls (20 distinct). Above A, six findings were common-only (all tank), 27 native-only and 12

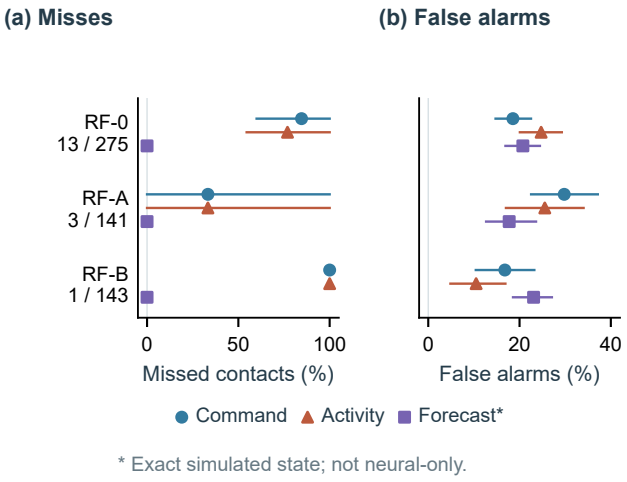


Fig. 4. Frozen secondary warning operating points. Rows state contact/success denominators; RF-0/A/B contain 24/12/12 independent seed clusters. Markers show (a) missed-contact and (b) false-alarm rates with pointwise 95% whole-seed bootstrap CIs. Activity is two-sided; the forecast holds the current command using exact simulated state. Positive-class support is 12/2/1 seed clusters. Zero-width and class-conditional empirical intervals do not establish zero population risk.

shared. Fly C=D; Full missed three consistent global-count offsets and three altered burst declarations.

Median valid-fixture D/A times were 1.32/0.0017 s (fly) and 0.0168/0.0018 s (tank), excluding 2.24-s registry setup. Sampled RSS peaked at 446 MiB including fixtures. A synthetic zero-neural logger also passes replay.

In 72 historical V8 records, 17 onsets were 10 ms late; ten completions lasted 440 rather than 450 ms (six at H). Declared windows overallocated 180 ms of observed fast motion; horizon-reaching active flags rescore from 13/17 to 7/17. Logged task labels remain consistent; effects of corrected actuation on contacts are unidentified.

V. Scope, Artifacts and Conclusion

Evidence concerns one graph, an assumed RF family, a synthetic plant, unequal healthy reserve and sparse failures. Roughly $66°$ held-out RMSE limits bearing reconstruction. Walk-only contact by 0.8 s reflects plant speeds; one burst followed by slower walking makes 1-s success finite-horizon preservation, not sustained avoidance. Functional row loss establishes no biological tolerance, device upset rate, hardware safety or energy/area benefit; trace consistency cannot authenticate neural execution.

The fixed snapshot [16] provides code, records, fixtures, per-case findings and execution entries; `PUBLICATION.md` separates generation from later analyses. Only neural reruns need external hash-matched matrices under upstream terms.

Paired task endpoints and measured audit gains separate fault consequences from record consistency. This task-level assessment provides a basis for evaluating how future device-level nonidealities propagate through neuromorphic controllers to closed-loop behavior.

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